Ellie (Gaeun) Choi

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EDUCATION

M.S. in Finance (MSF) + Graduate Certificate in FinTech Jan 2027 – Exp. Dec 2028
University of Utah, David Eccles School of Business | Salt Lake City, UT

B.S. in Information Systems Exp. Dec 2026
University of Utah, David Eccles School of Business | Salt Lake City, UT

- Minors: Business Analytics and Urban Ecology & Planning
- Relevant coursework: Blockchain for Business, Cloud Computing, Visual Analytics, GIS for Urban Ecologists

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Finance & Analytics: Financial reconciliation, budgeting & reporting, Excel modeling, SQL/MySQL, Python (pandas, scikit-learn, nltk), Tableau, Power BI

NLP & Machine Learning: FinBERT, VADER, Random Forest, LightGBM, Gradient Boosting, LLM evaluation (Gemma/Ollama)

Spatial & Tools: ArcGIS Pro, QGIS, GitHub, Google Colab, LucidChart, Salesforce, HTML/CSS, Java, Adobe Creative Suite, Figma

RESEARCH

Finance Chatbot Evaluation Research Fall 2026 – Present
Undergraduate Researcher | Faculty Mentor: Matt Pecsok | David Eccles School of Business, University of Utah

- Building an agent-based pipeline that simulates customer–chatbot conversations and scores responses to test whether prompt improvements create metric trade-offs (Python, Gemma/Ollama, Colab).

Predicting Stock Price Movements Using Market Data and Investor Sentiment 2026
Co-Author | Faculty Mentors: Emre Ertan, Chong Oh | David Eccles School of Business, University of Utah

- Combined S&P 500 prices (Yahoo Finance API) with FinBERT news-headline sentiment to predict next-day direction.
- Compared LightGBM, Random Forest, and Gradient Boosting with and without sentiment features using precision, recall, F1, and confusion matrices.

A Multidimensional Framework for Winning Super Bowl Advertising 2026
First Author | Faculty Advisor: Chong Oh | David Eccles School of Business, University of Utah

- Analyzed 64,230 tweets from 59 Super Bowl LX brands; engineered 6 metrics including ROI Efficiency ($8M cost baseline), Engagement Efficiency, and Sustained Ratio into a composite Winning Score Model.
- Found $R^2 < 0.05$ between Ad Meter rankings and Winning Score: viewer preference and digital engagement diverge.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Student Finance Operations Assistant 2026 – Present
College of Architecture & Planning, University of Utah | Salt Lake City, UT

- Process and reconcile student finance transactions and operational records, maintaining data integrity across budgeting and reporting workflows.
- Apply accounting fundamentals to resolve discrepancies; build standardized Excel benchmarking workbooks and validate formulas for internal planning data.

Teaching Assistant — IS 3060 (Information Systems) Aug 2025 – Present
David Eccles School of Business, University of Utah | Salt Lake City, UT

- Support 160+ students per semester through lab grading and 1-on-1 guidance on Tableau, Thunkable, and Google Cloud labs.
- Selected as TA for the 2025 Adobe Social Impact Challenge, advising teams and providing structured feedback.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Where Should You Invest in Salt Lake City? — GIS Investment Screening Summer 2026
CMP 4450: GIS for Urban Ecologists | University of Utah

- Scored all 2,711 SLC residential zones on a 0–3 composite index combining school, park, and TRAX transit access using ArcGIS Pro and five public UGRC datasets.
- Identified 713 full-access zones (26.3%); TRAX access was the bottleneck (742 zones vs. 2,678 for schools).

Uber Ride-Hailing Database Prototype Summer 2026
IS 4420: Database Fundamentals | Team of 3 | University of Utah

- Designed conceptual, logical, and physical ERDs for a 17-entity MySQL database; exported DDL and documented business rules and conflicting requirements.

LEADERSHIP & AWARDS

- Marketing Director, ISB Club (2025–2026); Lead Peer Advisor (2024); VP, Accounting Club and TEK (IS) Club (2023–2024).
- 1st Place, UAC Adobe Social Impact Challenge (Spring 2023) | New Horizon Scholarship, $2,000/yr. | Salesforce-Eccles Ideathon participant (Sep 2025).
- Music Director, short film "HELLPER" — Official Selection, Bucheon International Fantastic Film Festival (BIFAN) | Languages: Korean (Native), English (Professional Working Proficiency).